

VALERIA BODISHTIANU

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ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

The University of Western Australia
Lecturer (Assistant Professor)

Sep 2025 – Present

EDUCATION

Cornell University

Sep 2019 – Jun 2025

PhD in Economics

Thesis: Polarization under biased argument sharing

Committee: Kaushik Basu (chair), Lawrence Blume, Suraj Malladi

New Economic School, Russia, Moscow

Sep 2017 – Jun 2019

Master of Arts in Economics

Thesis: Media manipulation on a network with knowledgeable agents

Thesis advisor: Sergei Izmalkov

Higher School of Economics, Russia, Moscow

Sep 2013 – Jun 2017

Bachelor of Applied Mathematics and Information Science

Faculty of Computer Science

Thesis: Logic of Existentialism in Fiction

Thesis advisor: Ilya Makarov

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Information Economics, Game Theory, Networks, Artificial Intelligence, Political Economy

WORKING PAPERS

Shared Beliefs, Divergent Expression: Strategic Disclosure and Political Polarization.

Nudge versus Information Provision: An Experimental Study of Fact-checking Interventions with Dongfang Gaozhao and Pengfei Zhang.

Media Distortion and Expert Correction on Social Networks.

Sovereign Rating Changes and Flows to Emerging Markets: Best of Times, Worst of Times with Kaushik Basu and Supriyo De.

Pass It On, or Pay It Forward: Unfairness Spillovers in LLM Agents with Gleb Shevchuk-Genne, Mikhail Mozikov, Aleksei Stepin, Jiwei Zheng, Constantine Sorokin, Eyal Winter, and Ilia Makarov.

The Good, the Bad, and the Hulk-like GPT: Analyzing Emotional Decisions of Large Language Models in Cooperation and Bargaining Games with Mikhail Mozikov, Nikita Severin, Maria Glushanina, Mikhail Baklashkin, Andrey V. Savchenko, Ilya Makarov.

PUBLICATIONS

The Motivation and Consequence of Fact-checking Behavior: An Experimental Study with Dongfang Gaozhao (Dayton) and Pengfei Zhang (UT Dallas). *PLoS One* (2025), 20(5):e0323105.

EAI: Emotional Decision-Making of LLMs in Strategic Games and Ethical Dilemmas with Mikhail Mozikov, Nikita Severin, Maria Glushanina, Mikhail Baklashkin, Ivan Nasonov, Daniil Orekhov, Ivan Makovetskiy, Vasily Lavrentyev, Vladislav Pekhotin, Akim Tsvigun, Denis Turdakov, Tatiana Shavrina, Andrey V. Savchenko, Ilya Makarov. *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems 37 (NeurIPS 2024)*.

Logic of Existentialism in Fiction with Ilya Makarov. *Proceedings of the Thirtieth International Florida Artificial Intelligence Research Society Conference (FLAIRS 2017)*. AAAI Press, 2017.

Adapting First-Person Shooter Video Game for Playing with Virtual Reality Headsets with Ilya Makarov, Oleg Konoplia, Pavel Polyakov, Maxim Martynov, Peter Zyuzin, Olga Gerasimova. *Proceedings of the Thirtieth International Florida Artificial Intelligence Research Society Conference (FLAIRS 2017)*. AAAI Press, 2017.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Competition over a Network under Voter Fraud and Stubborn Agents.

Information Sharing and Fact-Checking Alignment in Large Language Models.

Statistical Discrimination Induced by The Rumors with Kalie Pierce (Cornell).

CONFERENCE & SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2026: HKUST (Guangzhou), Deakin University (upcoming), University of New South Wales (upcoming), University of Sydney (upcoming), Econometric Society Australasia Meeting (ESAM) (upcoming)

2024: Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Conference, Eastern Economic Association (EEA) Annual Conference, Cornell Work in Progress Seminar (TWIPS)

2023: Southern Economic Association (SEA) 93rd Annual Conference, Cornell Work in Progress Seminar (TWIPS)

2022: Committee on the Status of Women in the Economics Profession (CSWEP) Workshop, Cornell Work in Progress Seminar (TWIPS)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

ECON 3301: Game Theory and Decision Making,
Instructor of Record 2026
The University of Western Australia

ECON 1101: Introduction to Microeconomics,
Instructor of Record 2026
The University of Western Australia

ECON 3280: Introduction to Political Economy for Public Policy,
Teaching Assistant Spring 2025
Prof. Milena Djourelova, Cornell University

ECON 3801: Introduction to Game Theory and Strategic Thinking, Fall 2024, 2021, 2020
Teaching Assistant
Prof. Kaushik Basu, Cornell University

ECON 6100: Microeconomic Theory II (PhD sequence),
Teaching Assistant Spring 2023
Prof. Lawrence Blume, Cornell University

ECON 2040: Networks, Teaching Assistant Fall 2022
Prof. David Easley, Prof. Jon Kleinberg, Cornell University

ECON 4020: Game Theory I, Teaching Assistant Spring 2022
Prof. Tommaso Denti, Cornell University

ECON 1110: Introductory Microeconomics, Teaching Assistant Spring 2021
Prof. Jennifer Wissink, Cornell University

FELLOWSHIPS AND GRANTS

UWA Business School Research Grant, University of Western Australia 2026
Sage Graduate Fellowship, Cornell University 2019-2024
Graduate School Conference Grant, Cornell University 2023-2024
Committee on the Status of Women in the Economics Profession (CSWEP) Travel Grant 2022
Computer Science Department Travel Grant, Higher School of Economics 2016

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Mentor, Graduate Student Association For Economics, Cornell University 2021-2024
Voting Member, Diversity in Cornell Economics Association (DICE), Cornell University 2022-2024
Research Intern, Hydrometeorological Centre of Russia, Moscow 2016
Research Intern, Sberbank CIB, Moscow 2015

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Computer Skills	Python, Stata, R, Matlab, SQL
Languages	Russian (native), English (fluent)

REFERENCES

Kaushik Basu (Dissertation Chair)

Carl Marks Professor of International Studies
Department of Economics
Cornell University
Email: kb40@cornell.edu

Suraj Malladi

Assistant Professor of Managerial Economics
& Decision Sciences
Kellogg Business School
Northwestern University
Email: suraj.malladi@kellogg.northwestern.edu

Lawrence Blume

Distinguished Professor of Arts and Sciences
in Economics
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